



FACULTY OF ENGINEERING, SCIENCES AND TECHNOLOGY

ASSIGNMENT # 1

By

NAME: Abdullah Shah Alam

ID: IU04-0123-0462

Course: Philosophy & Critical Thinking

Faculty: Professor Dr. Sajida Perveen

ASSIGNMENT 1

Critical Thinking: Challenge Your Thinking

Topic: Would You Change Your Mind?

Instructions

Read the following situation carefully:

A student receives a message on social media claiming that “Artificial Intelligence will replace most human jobs within the next 10 years.” The student immediately believes the claim and starts telling others that there will be no need to study or develop professional skills because AI will do everything.

Task

You are asked to critically examine this situation. **Do not simply agree or disagree with the statement.** Think deeply about the claim and justify your reasoning.

Answer the following:

1. **What assumptions** is the student making?
2. What questions would you ask **before accepting the claim as true**?
3. What evidence would you need to decide whether the claim is reliable?
4. Can you identify any **bias, exaggeration, or logical error** in the student's thinking?
5. What could be an **alternative explanation or viewpoint**?
6. If you disagree with the claim, construct a strong argument against it.
7. If you agree with the claim, construct a strong argument supporting it.
8. **What would convince you to change your mind?** Explain.
9. Imagine that five years later you discover that your original conclusion was wrong. **What might you have overlooked?**
10. Finally, give your own conclusion: **Should we fear the future of AI, prepare for it, or look at it differently? Why?**

Critical Thinking Challenge

Your answer will be evaluated not on whether you **agree or disagree**, but on **how well you think**.

Your response should demonstrate:

- Questioning of assumptions
- Logical reasoning
- Evaluation of evidence
- Recognition of bias
- Consideration of alternative perspectives
- Ability to challenge your own conclusion
- A clear and justified final position

Final Reflection

Complete this sentence in your own words:

“After completing this activity, I realized that critical thinking means _____ because _____.”

ANSWER:

1. What assumptions is the student making?

The student is assuming that the message on social media is completely true just because it was shared online. He is also assuming that AI will develop very fast and replace almost every job in exactly ten years, without checking any real source or expert opinion. Another assumption is that skills and education will become useless, which is a very big jump from just one social media post.

2. What questions would you ask before accepting the claim as true?

Who made this claim, and are they an expert in AI or technology, or just someone sharing an opinion to get reactions? Is there any actual research behind it, or is it just a guess? Since Chatgpt was the first major AI tool launched in 2022, I would want to know exactly how many jobs have really been eliminated from 2022 up to now in 2026, and in which specific domains this actually happened, instead of accepting a vague statement about a most jobs. I would also want to know the background of the person who posted this claim on social media. Do they have any real technical or AI-related knowledge, or are they simply trying to create a reaction and get views by posting something dramatic and unverified?

3. What evidence would you need to decide whether the claim is reliable?

I would want to see actual statistics from 2022 to 2026 showing exactly which domains AI has genuinely helped in, and whether job requirements in those same domains actually increased or decreased over that period, instead of relying on general opinions. Personally, I believe AI does help us, but based on real evidence from the last four years, only certain domains have been affected, not "most jobs" as the claim suggests. Even if I look at the tech industry itself, research shows that senior developers now mainly review and analyze code generated by AI rather than losing their jobs to it. However, it would be incorrect to say that everyone is losing their job. It is mainly junior developers, who used to handle basic coding tasks, and other roles that involved basic human tasks, that are now being replaced or reduced, while experienced professionals are simply being assisted by AI rather than eliminated by it.

4. Can you identify any bias, exaggeration, or logical error in the student's thinking?

Yes. The student is showing confirmation bias because he accepted the claim immediately without questioning it, just because it matched an exciting or scary idea. There is also exaggeration in the claim itself, since saying AI will replace "most" jobs in only ten years is a very strong statement without proof. This is also a hasty

generalization, which means he is making a big conclusion from very little evidence, just one social media post.

5. What could be an alternative explanation or viewpoint?

Instead of completely replacing jobs, AI might change how jobs are done. Many jobs could become easier or faster with AI as a tool, while some tasks inside a job get automated but the job itself still needs a human, for example doctors, teachers, or managers who still need judgment and human interaction. AI may also create new jobs that do not even exist yet, such as AI trainers, data analysts, or AI safety experts.

6. If you disagree with the claim, construct a strong argument against it.

AI is good at repetitive and rule based tasks, but most jobs need creativity, emotional understanding, decision making, and human interaction, which AI still cannot fully do. History also shows that new technologies like computers and factory machines did remove some old jobs, but they created many new ones as well. Also, building and training AI systems, maintaining them, and making ethical decisions about them will itself need a large number of skilled human workers, so AI is more likely to change jobs than fully eliminate most of them.

7. If you agree with the claim, construct a strong argument supporting it.

AI is already automating tasks in customer service, data entry, translation, and even basic writing and coding, and it is improving very quickly. Many companies are already replacing certain roles with AI tools to cut costs and increase speed. If this trend continues at the same fast pace, it is possible that within ten years a large number of routine and repetitive jobs could be handled mostly by AI, which would support the claim to some extent.

8. What would convince you to change your mind? Explain.

Strong, updated data from reliable research organizations, real numbers showing how many jobs have actually been lost or created because of AI, and clear expert consensus would convince me. If most economists and technology researchers agreed that this trend is really happening at that speed, backed by proper studies rather than social media posts, I would take the claim much more seriously.

9. Imagine that five years later you discover that your original conclusion was wrong. What might you have overlooked?

I might have overlooked how slow real world adoption of technology usually is, since companies, governments, and laws take time to adjust. I might have also ignored the fact that human skills like creativity, trust, and emotional connection are hard to fully replace.

I could have missed how new jobs related to AI itself might appear and balance out the jobs that were lost.

10. Finally, give your own conclusion: Should we fear the future of AI, prepare for it, or look at it differently? Why?

I believe we should prepare for it rather than fear it or ignore it. Fear leads to giving up on learning, which is exactly the mistake the student in the situation made. AI is a tool that is changing how work is done, so instead of avoiding education and skills, people should focus on learning skills that AI cannot easily copy, such as critical thinking, creativity, and adaptability. This way, AI becomes something we work with instead of something we are replaced by.

Final Reflection (Conclusion)

After completing this activity, I realized that critical thinking means not accepting information just because it sounds convincing or is shared by many people, because it made me question a claim instead of blindly believing or rejecting it. I realized this because when I actually broke the AI job claim into assumptions, evidence, and alternative views, my opinion became much more balanced and realistic than my first reaction to it.